

Ignisia Club at MIT World Peace University Pune presents

INCUBEX 2026

A national-level tech launchpad by Ignisia

From Vision To Venture.

Ignisia Club at MIT World Peace University Pune presents | Powered by Unstop



INDEX

Sr. No.	Title	Page No.
1	About MIT-WPU	1
2	About Ignisia Club	1
3	About INCUBEX 2026 & Participants	2
4	Schedule & Tracks	3
5	Event Flow, Fees & Prizes	4
6	Guidelines	5
7	Evaluation Criteria	6
8	Contact Us	7

1. ABOUT MIT-WPU

Dr. Vishwanath Karad MIT World Peace University (MIT-WPU), Pune, is one of India's most distinguished institutions dedicated to academic excellence, innovation, and value-based education since 1983. Located in Kothrud, Pune, the university has grown into a vibrant educational hub offering diverse undergraduate, postgraduate, and doctoral programs across disciplines such as engineering, management, science, design, law, and liberal arts. Built on the unique philosophy of integrating science, technology, and spiritual values, MIT-WPU aims to nurture responsible professionals who contribute meaningfully to society and global progress. The university strongly promotes interdisciplinary learning, research-driven education, and an entrepreneurial mindset, encouraging students to develop creative solutions for real-world challenges.

MIT-WPU stands as one of the university's strongest academic pillars, offering specialized programs across fields such as Computer Engineering, Artificial Intelligence & Data Science, Mechanical Engineering, Civil Engineering, Electronics & Communication, and Robotics. With advanced laboratories, innovation and research centers, and product-based learning environments, students gain strong technical foundations alongside practical industry exposure. Through hackathons, research initiatives, industry collaborations, and entrepreneurship support, MIT-WPU's engineering ecosystem empowers students to develop impactful technologies and become future-ready engineers capable of solving complex global challenges.

2. ABOUT IGNISIA CLUB

Ignisia is a student-led club at MIT-WPU focused on fostering innovation, technical learning, and collaboration among students. The club aims to create opportunities for students to explore emerging technologies, work on practical problems, and showcase their ideas on a larger platform.

Previously, Ignisia organised a national-level AI Hackathon that witnessed participation from more than 1,600 students from across India. The hackathon provided a platform for students to collaborate and develop AI-based solutions focused on real-world and social-impact challenges, resulting in a strong and meaningful learning experience for the participants.

Building on this experience, Ignisia now aims to expand its activities towards stronger academic and innovation outcomes. The club seeks to bring MIT-WPU and its students onto a national platform, while creating opportunities for students to strengthen their technical skills, explore AI research, and develop an entrepreneurial mindset. Through initiatives such as INCUBEX 2026, Ignisia aims to build a stronger culture of innovation, research, collaboration, and product development within the MIT-WPU student community.

Club Goal: Think. Build. *Evolve.*

3. ABOUT INCUBEX 2026 & PARTICIPANTS

About INCUBEX 2026

INCUBEX 2026 is Ignisia Club's national-level deep tech summit at MIT-WPU — a platform that bridges the gap between student innovation and real-world impact, helping convert student products into working prototypes and, eventually, into products. The event brings together student innovators, industry experts, mentors, and potential investors to evaluate, refine, and connect student concepts with growth opportunities.

Unlike a traditional hackathon, INCUBEX is an expo-style summit where student teams present their products — whether academic builds, functional models, or operational ventures — to expert panels in a structured evaluation environment. Selected teams gain direct access to incubation programs, investor pitching channels, and mentorship networks.

INCUBEX 2026 follows a hybrid format with online screening rounds and an offline *Grand Finale on 21st October 2026* at MIT-WPU Campus, Pune.

Key Objectives of INCUBEX 2026

- Offer a national stage for students to present working prototypes and products.
- Encourage practical problem-solving across key domains like AI, hardware, sustainability, and healthcare.
- Connect student teams with industry mentors, feedback, and potential incubation or investment channels.
- Strengthen ties between MIT-WPU, academic institutions, and the broader product ecosystem.

Participants

- **Target Audience:** College students (Diploma, UG & PG) from institutions across India are eligible to participate.
- **Product Track:** Teams of 1 to 6 members presenting operational ventures or working products.
- **Prototype & Product Expo Track:** Teams of 3 to 6 members presenting academic products, functional models, or early-stage technical builds.
- A functional working product or prototype is mandatory for the Grand Finale — purely theoretical concepts are not eligible.
- **On-Campus Finalists:** 30 Product Track teams and 50 Prototype & Product Expo Track teams — a total of 80 finalist teams — will be shortlisted for the Grand Finale.
- The Grand Finale will be held on-campus at MIT-World Peace University, Pune, Maharashtra.

4. SCHEDULE & TRACKS

Schedule

Activity	Date
Registration & National Outreach	25th September – 2nd October 2026
Online Submission Deadline	5th October 2026
Qualifier Round (Online Live Presentations)	6th – 7th October 2026
Result Declaration	9th October 2026
Announcement of Finalists	Mid October 2026
Grand Finale (On-Campus)	21st October 2026
Post-Event Opportunities	Post 21st October 2026

Tracks

INCUBEX 2026 operates across two primary tracks to evaluate products based on their current stage of development.

Product Track — For student teams presenting operational ventures, working software/hardware products, or commercial business models. Products must fall under one of the following themes:

- Digital & Software Ventures — SaaS, FinTech, EdTech, mobile apps, and digital platforms.
- Smart Systems & Hardware — Robotics, IoT systems, consumer electronics, and physical devices.
- Open Innovation — Unconventional business models, novel services, and cross-domain products.

Prototype & Product Expo Track — For academic products, research builds, functional models, and early-stage technical concepts. Prototypes must fall under one of the following themes:

Software & Digital Innovation

- AI for Bharat
- Healthcare and Accessibility
- Education & Learning Systems
- Climate, Energy and Sustainability
- AgriTech, Food Tech and Rural Livelihoods
- FinTech, GovTech and Public Rails
- Peace, Ethics and Social Impact
- Open Software Innovation

Hardware & Physical Engineering

- Robotics & Drones
- Embedded Systems & IoT
- Manufacturing
- DeepTech
- Open Hardware Innovation

5. EVENT FLOW, FEES & PRIZES

Qualifier Round – Online PPT Submission & Live Presentation

Registered teams submit their product details using the official PPT template, along with a prototype explanation video and a functional demo link (where applicable). Shortlisted teams then present their submitted PPTs live in an online pitch session before an evaluation panel of industry experts and jury members. Teams are evaluated on the following:

- **Product Track:** Market need, product viability, technical feasibility, and business potential.
- **Prototype Track:** Problem relevance, novelty, working functionality, and technical execution.

Grand Finale – On-Site Exhibition & Pitching (21st October 2026)

Finalist teams are invited to MIT-WPU Campus, Pune. The day includes live product pitching, prototype exhibitions, closed-door jury evaluation rounds, and an open exhibition for guests and delegates. This stage tests technical depth, innovation, clarity of presentation, and readiness for real-world deployment.

Registration & Fees

- **Registration Fee:** ₹200 per team.
- **Grand Finale Participation Fee:** Teams selected as finalists for the offline Grand Finale will be required to pay an additional ₹600 per team towards participation.
- **Product Readiness Requirement:** Teams participating in the Product Track should demonstrate a Technology Readiness Level (TRL) of 5–7, indicating that their technology has progressed beyond the conceptual or early development stage and reached a level suitable for meaningful demonstration and evaluation.

Prizes

Product Track

- Top-performing startups receive direct pitch access to angel investors, venture funds, and ecosystem partners for seed funding, equity investment, and acceleration support. Direct entry or fast-tracked screening for incubation programs offered by partner hubs and MIT-WPU Innovation Centres.

Prototype & Product Expo Track

- Cash prizes, trophies, and certificates awarded to 1st, 2nd, and 3rd place winners.
- 3 Consolation Prizes for standout technical builds and high-potential products.
- 2 MIT-WPU Institutional Awards reserved exclusively for outstanding MIT-WPU student teams.

All Participants

- Participation certificates for all shortlisted teams competing in the Grand Finale.
- Select teams across both tracks will gain access to mentorship networks, technical credits, and industry guidance.

Note: Specific cash prize amounts, sponsor vouchers, and goodies will be finalized and announced prior to the final event communications.

6. GUIDELINES

Track-Specific Rules

- **Product Track:** Teams can consist of 1 to 6 members. A functional, working product or service is mandatory. Concepts in the ideation stage without a tangible product are not eligible.
- **Prototype & Product Expo Track:** Teams must consist of 3 to 6 members. A functional prototype build (hardware build or software model) is mandatory for live demonstration. Slide-only or purely theoretical concepts are not eligible.

General Rules (Applicable to All Tracks)

- **Registration:** Each team must register through the Unstop platform. Multiple submissions from the same team may lead to disqualification.
- **Originality of Work:** All submitted ideas, prototypes, products, and presentations must be the original work of the participating team. Any form of plagiarism or unauthorized IP use will lead to immediate disqualification.
- **Live Pitching & Online Screening:** Shortlisted teams must present their slides live before the jury during the online screening round and be physically present for the Grand Finale at the MIT-WPU campus.
- **Decision Finality:** The decisions of the judging panel and the organizing committee regarding shortlisting, evaluation scores, and awards are final and binding.
- **Reporting & Identification:** Participants must carry their College ID proof and a valid Government ID for verification. Event ID passes will only be issued upon physical ID verification.
- **Personal Equipment:** Teams must bring their own laptops, devices, chargers, extension boards, demo apparatus, and personal medicines.
- **Code of Conduct:** Professional behaviour, respect, and decorum toward fellow competitors, judges, and volunteers are mandatory. Any form of misconduct or harassment will result in immediate elimination and removal from campus.

7. EVALUATION CRITERIA

Teams will be evaluated on the following criteria based on their track:

Product Track

Criteria	Weightage
Problem & Market Need	20%
Product & Technical Feasibility	25%
Business Model & Traction	25%
Competitive Advantage & IP	15%
Pitch & Jury Q&A	15%

Prototype & Product Expo Track

Criteria	Weightage
Working Prototype & Functionality	35%
Innovation & Originality	20%
Technical Complexity & Execution	20%
Real-World Impact & Feasibility	15%
Demonstration & Presentation	10%

8. CONTACT US

Ignisia Club, MIT-WPU



ignisia@mitwpu.edu.in



Instagram: @ignisiamit



X (Twitter): @ignisiamit



LinkedIn: @Ignisia